end of the decade the group had an extensive reach domestically and transnationally.

Beyond serving missionary and training purposes, Lashkar used its infrastructure in Pakistan to recruit and raise money. It also developed networks abroad for the same purpose, in India, the Persian Gulf and the West. Its approach was based both on what the market would bear in each location as well as on what it endeavored to gain from each theater. Within Pakistan, the group sought fighters, support staff and donors. The overwhelming majority of Lashkar's fighters came from Pakistan, with the remainder drawn primarily from Afghanistan and Indian-administered Kashmir.[77] Before the 9/11 attacks no restrictions were placed on private Pakistani citizens joining militant groups or on those groups raising money for jihad.[78] By the end of the 1990s the group had little trouble attracting recruits, support staff or money in Pakistan.

Things were not always so easy for Lashkar. Jihadi organizations in Pakistan don't draw exclusively from their own sect, but they do rely on their own sectarian infrastructure. Here Lashkar was out of luck on two counts. First, the Ahl-e-Hadith movement's infrastructure in Pakistan was not as robust as that of the Deobandis'. Second, Lashkar was estranged from the other Ahl-e-Hadith organizations and so was unable to recruit in Ahl-e-Hadith madaris or mosques. One might expect that Lashkar relied heavily on its Al-Dawa schools as feeders for its militant jihad, but the group believed the quality of student produced at these schools was far too high to waste as cannon fodder. The group's founders wanted the MDI school system to be among Pakistan's best, and so did not wish to compromise access to potential students by using those schools as nothing more than a battlefield feeder. Of course, if students wanted to fight then Lashkar did not turn all of them away, though it did steer some toward further education and then into non-military roles in MDI. Many of its above-ground workers, first at MDI and later at JuD, were graduates of its school system. Other graduates went on to become productive members of society in various fields, which increased Lashkar's power and reach in Pakistan.

Even after opening new madaris, built by its Department of Construction of Masajid and Madaris, very few of Lashkar's recruits, percentage-wise, came from a madrasa.[79] In contrast, Deobandi jihadi groups relied much